Daggers
The samurai carried the *tanto*, a small dagger that he kept hidden in his armour. The *tanto* scabbard contained a *kozuka* (small knife) and a *kogai* (skewer). A *kozuka* was more likely to be used as a paper knife than as a weapon. The *kogai* was primarily an implement in arranging a samurai's hair.
Lacquered *tanto* scabbard
Ear cleaner on end of handle
This particular example of a *kozuka* adjoined the scabbard of a *wakazashi* sword
KOGAIS
KOZUKAS
*Shinogi* (blade ridge)
*Sageo* (cord) for tying scabbard into belt
*Tsuba* (guard)
*Tsuka* (hilt)
*Menuki* (hilt ornament)
Silk brade binding
*Kogai* (hair implement)
Wakazashi sword
The *wakazashi* was a samurai's constant companion, worn from waking until sleeping, and even kept near to hand during the night. As well as serving as an additional fighting sword to the *katana* and as, in effect, a side-arm, it was often the weapon used by the samurai to perform ritual suicide *(seppuku)*.
Wakazashi sword and scabbard
A *wakazashi* is a sword with a blade 30–60cm (12–14in) long. Japanese blades are also differentiated by details of shape and by their *hamon* – the line left between the areas of the blade covered and uncovered during the tempering process. There are various patterns of *hamon*, some associated with specific swordsmiths.
*Kissaki* (point)